

Boston Sunday Globe

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JANUARY 26, 2025

Now coming to state capitals: mini DOGEs

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Even as President Trump signed an executive order officially creating the “Department of Government Efficiency” last week, basic questions are still swirling about the scope and structure of his government-slashing initiative spearheaded by billionaire Elon Musk.

But one legacy of the project has already come into focus: a crop of imitators, sprouting up in state capitals

around the country, hoping to apply the crusading, spending-slashing ethos of DOGE to their own governments.

In recent weeks, Republican officials in several states have announced formal efforts explicitly based on DOGE: New Hampshire, Wisconsin, Oklahoma, Iowa, Missouri, Kansas, Louisiana, and Arizona.

Upon being sworn in as New Hampshire governor on Jan. 9, Kelly Ayotte’s very first

DOGE, Page A12

‘The best the government can do is . . . say, “OK, we’ve gone through all our files. . . . It’s up to history to decide.” ’

REX BRADFORD, *Mary Ferrell Foundation*



JFK files may quiet — or fuel — conspiracy talk

60-plus years later, Americans still clamor for details

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The assassination of President John F. Kennedy spurred the original deep-state conspiracy theory, fueled in part by millions of pages of classified records that have been slowly — but not yet completely — made available to a public still fascinated by the tragedy more than six decades later.

PHOTO ILLUSTRATION/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A 2023 Gallup Poll found just 29 percent of adults think JFK was killed by a single assassin.

Now, the remaining 3,000 or so documents that were fully or partially withheld are set to be released soon after President Trump signed an executive order Thursday declassifying them, along with the remaining sealed records of the assassinations of civil rights leader Martin Luther King Jr. and Senator Robert F. Kennedy. Experts on the John Kennedy assassination aren’t expecting any game-changing evidence, but rather the last pieces of a historical record that remains a giant unfinished jigsaw puzzle.

Still, they predicted the release of the final records — assuming some aren’t withheld because of continued national security concerns — is unlikely

JFK, Page A13

Accusers upset at pace of doctor case

Difficult to prove assaults during medical exams

By Liz Kowalczyk

GLOBE STAFF

This story contains graphic descriptions of alleged sexual assault that readers may find upsetting.

The indictment this month of a former Brigham and Women’s Hospital doctor for allegedly raping two patients brought some solace for the more than 200 patients who have accused him of sexual assault.

But many remain frustrated and confused about why the prominent rheumatologist, Dr. Derrick Todd, hasn’t faced more criminal repercussions more quickly given the vast number of accusations that surfaced more than a year ago.

Police in Boston and Framingham, where Todd practiced, have interviewed dozens of former patients since the summer of 2023, when Todd was forced to resign from the

TODD, Page A15

President Trump fired at least 12 inspectors general, apparently defying a law that requires 30 days’ advance notice to Congress before any inspector general is removed. **A12.**

A warm turn

Sunday: Partly sunny, breezy.

High: 38-43. Low: 21-26.

Monday: Much the same.

Sunrise: 7:03 Sunset: 4:51

Complete report, **A22.**

Deaths, **A16-21.**

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The number of 311 service requests for needle pickups surged nearly **50%** in the final six months of last year, compared with the same period in 2023.

The increase started after the city halted a COVID-era needle collection.

On city streets, a scourge of dirty needles

Complaints about discarded drug paraphernalia soar after collection program ends



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Azzy-Mae Ní Mháille, from a mobile prevention team, reached under a bush for a discarded syringe near Mass. and Cass.

By Chris Serres and Neena Hagen

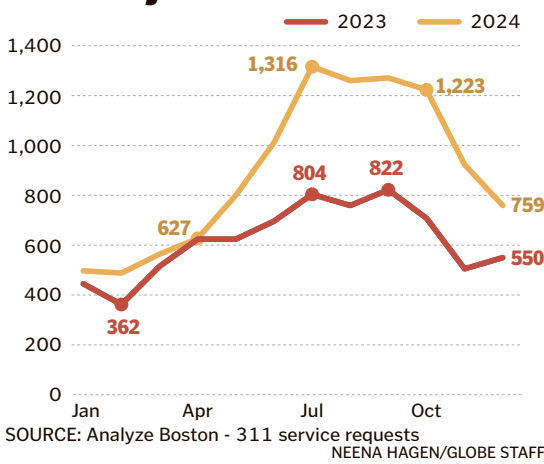
GLOBE STAFF

Shortly after sunrise, John Gobbi stepped gingerly across a sidewalk in Boston’s South End strewn with dirty and discarded drug needles. Every so often his work boots crushed another syringe, some still caked with blood, producing a sharp crunch-crunch-crunch sound in the cold morning air.

“The needles are everywhere,” said Gobbi, a landscaping worker from Dorchester, after receiving his daily dose of methadone at the clinic. “It’s like an out-of-control disease.”

They are the visible debris of the deadly opioid scourge, and they are appearing in greater numbers in public spaces all over the city, from Boston Common to Nubian Square in Roxbury. People injecting drugs are discarding the used needles in parks, playgrounds, and transit stops, because they have few

311 needle pickup requests in Boston by month 2023-24



SOURCE: Analyze Boston - 311 service requests
NEENA HAGEN/GLOBE STAFF

safe places to discard them and little financial incentive to pick them up.

While long a problem, the proliferation of discarded needles has reached crisis levels since city officials abruptly ended a popular program last June that paid drug users to collect them. The number of 311 service requests for needle pickups surged nearly 50 percent in the final six months of last year, compared with the same period in 2023. Needle-pickup requests last year reached the highest level since the program’s inception in December 2020 — with an average of 1,125 requests a month, according to a review of 311 requests.

City crews and community groups that run needle exchange programs are scrambling to contain the problem, which has been exacerbated by a surging homeless population and persistently high rates

NEEDLES, Page A15

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